



Niantic bans cheaters

Niantic says they'll perma-ban Pokémon GO cheaters and ToS violators.

<http://dgit.in/pkmpban>



Hacking by sound

Hackers can steal your data by listening to the sound made by your computer's hard drive.

<http://dgit.in/sbysound>

Geek Life

- Facebook Timeline- Started out as the pet project of an employee, the timeline feature was originally called 'memories'. After an employee had the initial idea, he gathered a team of 4 and build a working demo in one night at the next hackathon. The feature was deployed to all the Facebook customers within the next 6 months, making it one of the fastest and biggest update rollout to the site.
- 'Like' Button- Believe it or not, the like button hasn't always been there. In one such hackathons, while trying to think of a more easy and creative way to let people acknowledge each other's status updates, photos and comments, the like button was conceived.
- Many other small and nifty features like uploading videos, tagging people in comments, and the latest update to the calendar view, all are a result of the famous hack fests of the company.

IBM Jams

Started off as an employee only event, IBM jam has grown into a fully fledged management tool that aims to drive "innovation and collaboration". Jams are basically massive brainstorming sessions, somewhat similar to hackathons, but more focused on a particular issue or projects. People from different fields of expertise come and collaborate together to find and develop innovative solutions to problems.

One of the biggest and most successful 'jam' was organised in the year 2006 and saw more than 150,000 people from 104 countries and 67 companies, come together to innovate and create. The 'Jam' concluded with IBM investing \$100 million in the 10 ideas that came out of it.

A 'Take as you need' vacation policy and wild hackathons- Yammer

Yammer is a freemium social network service company that was bought by Microsoft in the year 2012 and has an office culture that offers its employees

high flexibility and lets them constantly keep innovating. The company has a 'take as you need' vacation policy. After all what better way to recharge your mind than taking a holiday whenever you want to. Also, just like



A hackathon underway at the Yahoo office



'The Garage' is filled with every tech toy and world class tool imaginable.

it's parent company, Yammer organizes regular hackathons but with a twist. Each hackathon is set up like a 24 hour wild costume party where geeks in the company come to chill, discuss ideas and create new and interesting things.

Hi-Tech workspaces Area 404

Long gone are the days when Facebook was just a social networking startup. It has been building its own data centers from scratch since 2011 and bought the Virtual Reality company Oculus. The new Area 404 is a big step in the same direction. Spanning more than 22,000 square feet, the newly inaugurated hardware laboratory labeled Area 404 is one of "biggest" and "most advanced" labs built by the company according to Mark Zuckerberg. The

lab is divided into 2 main areas, an electrical engineering lab and the prototyping workshop, both of which are equipped with state of the art machines and tools to enable its employees to innovate and create faster.

'The Garage'

The story of how Microsoft was started in a garage by 2 intelligent, creative people who turned it into a multinational billion dollar company, is not unknown. To pay homage to its origin, the company turned Bill Gate's old office into something called 'The Garage'. The place filled with every tech toy and world class tool imaginable, is open to all Microsoft employees. Infact the employees are encouraged to use the space to work on their pet projects and special 'Garage weeks' are organised for each product team.

X Labs

Founded in the year 2010, Google's X facility is a secret R&D facility located about a half a mile from Googleplex. X, a subsidiary of Alphabet,

has no CEO. Instead it is overseen by an entrepreneur scientist Astro Teller, whose official title is "Captain of Moonshots". Moonshots are the various innovative new projects which scientists at X are working on.

Unlike Google's main campus, where engineers work on company's main products, at X the focus is on innovation and solving various global problems. The list of projects and products include a number of innovative things, not all of which have been successful. This hasn't stopped the company from investing in innovation and creativity. Projects developed in X include Google Brain, Google Glass, long lasting batteries and Google's Self Driving car, a couple of which even saw commercial prototypes being shared at consumer events.